BUSINESS PROCESS MANAGEMENT (BPM) ROADMAP SUPPLEMENTAL GUIDE

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The materials presented in this technical guideline provide specific supplemental information into OUM for the purposes of creating a BPM Roadmap. The BPM Roadmap Supplemental Guide contains the following components:

BPM Roadmap Overview

This component provides an overview of the concepts of BPM Roadmap creation.

BPM Roadmap Supplemental Task Guidelines

The Supplemental Task Guidelines should be used in conjunction with the standard OUM tasks in order to accomplish BPM Roadmap work at the detail task level.

PDF View

You may also prefer to access this information through the **BPM Roadmap Supplemental Guide (PDF View)** located in the Supplemental Guides section of the Supplemental Guidance page.

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PURPOSE

The purpose of this document is to provide an overview of a BPM Roadmap engagement, and to provide implementation teams with *supplemental guidance* for the successful planning and creation of BPM Roadmap.

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AUDIENCE

This document is intended for practitioners who will be delivering BPM Roadmap engagements based on the OUM (Oracle Unified Method) approach.

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HOW TO USE THIS DOCUMENT

This document contains supplemental guidance for planning and executing BPM Roadmap engagements and should be used in conjunction with and not instead of the OUM base method guidance. In many cases, the work that needs to be done for the BPM Roadmap creation is fully contained within the OUM task and technique files, therefore, no task supplement is needed for that task.

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LIMITATIONS TO THIS DOCUMENT

This document does not describe OUM in detail – the reader must review the documentation and training materials referenced below to gain a basic understanding of each.

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RELATED DOCUMENTATION AND TRAINING

The following related documentation & training provide additional detailed guidance related to OUM implementations and are prerequisites to this document:

- OUM Method Pack – Desktop Installable or Hosted version
- OUM Training and Accreditation Program

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BUSINESS PROCESS MANAGEMENT (BPM) ROADMAP OVERVIEW

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WHAT IS BPM ROADMAP?

A Business Process Management (BPM) Roadmap provides the guidance to successfully adopt a business process oriented approach to building IT solutions to support the business. A well constructed BPM Roadmap defines projects that incrementally deliver BPM and provide business value at each step while minimizing the risks associated with BPM adoption. To build such a roadmap requires a solid understanding of the current situation with respect to BPM, a clear vision of what the BPM initiative needs to accomplish to be successful, and a structured approach to defining the iterations that comprise the path to successful BPM adoption.

Background

This BPM Roadmap view is intended to show how to conduct an engagement using OUM to create a BPM Roadmap based on the BPM Roadmap described in the IT Strategies from Oracle (ITSO) guidelines and reference architectures library, Creating a BPM Roadmap. Refer to the Supplemental Guidance page for further information on the IT Strategies from Oracle (ITSO) web site.

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WHEN DO YOU USE THE BPM ROADMAP VIEW?

This view is useful as follows:

- First, if you are planning to create a BPM Roadmap based on the ITSO Creating a BPM Roadmap, then this view helps you see which OUM tasks align with the document. Viewing the BPM Roadmap Supplemental Task Guidelines, you can easily associate the guidelines provided in the ITSO Creating a BPM Roadmap back to the OUM task guidelines. Doing so will help you provide a good foundation for any later programs or projects that may be initiated as a result of the roadmap. This is particularly useful if these programs or projects will use OUM, and they can better relate to the material produced from the roadmap, as the outcome itself is aligned with OUM. This allows work product artifacts of the BPM Roadmap effort to be consumed by the actual delivery projects, as necessary.

- Second, this view may be helpful if you plan to execute an OUM project that has been initiated from a BPM Roadmap made using the ITSO Creating a BPM Roadmap. In this situation, use this view during the Start Up phase to see how the material produced from the roadmap can be mapped to OUM tasks.

The main objective of this view is to **minimize the gap between BPM Roadmap engagements and subsequent implementation projects**.

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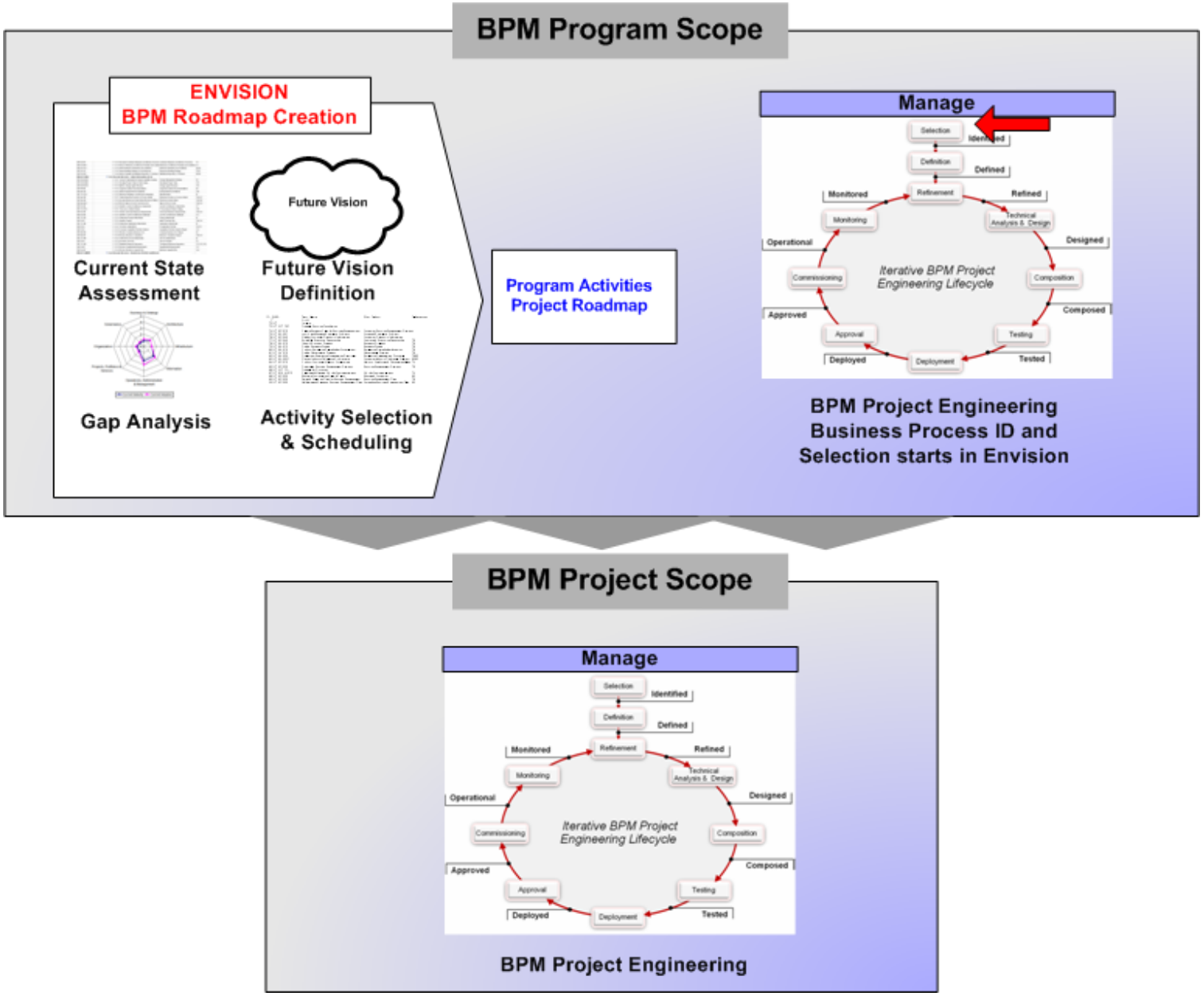
BPM ROADMAP OVERVIEW

A BPM Roadmap provides guidance to the BPM initiative allowing multiple projects to progress in parallel yet remain coordinated. This approach ultimately results in a common end goal that provides value greater than the sum of the individual projects. The BPM Roadmap consists of two fundamental parts:

- program-level efforts
- a portfolio of projects that build specific business process solutions

The relationship for these two fundamental parts within OUM is illustrated in the figure below:



The program-level efforts create the assets that are leveraged across all the individual projects. Examples include the BPM Reference Architecture, governance policies and processes, standards, metrics, training and mentoring, business process engineering method, etc. The program level efforts provide and enforce the necessary consistency required to succeed at BPM adoption. A delicate balance needs to be struck between too little control and too much control. With too little control BPM adoption will be haphazard at best.

For most companies it is advantageous to separate the business process infrastructure deployment and configuration into a separate project from the business solution projects. This allows the infrastructure project to focus on creating a sound business process infrastructure that meets the needs of multiple business solution projects. There will likely be an infrastructure project for each phase of the BPM Roadmap to incrementally deploy the process infrastructure. The business process to be managed by the BPM system typically already exists as the creation of an entirely new process is an unusual case, so the activities, both human and system, already exist in some form. The challenge for a BPM project is how to integrate these activities.

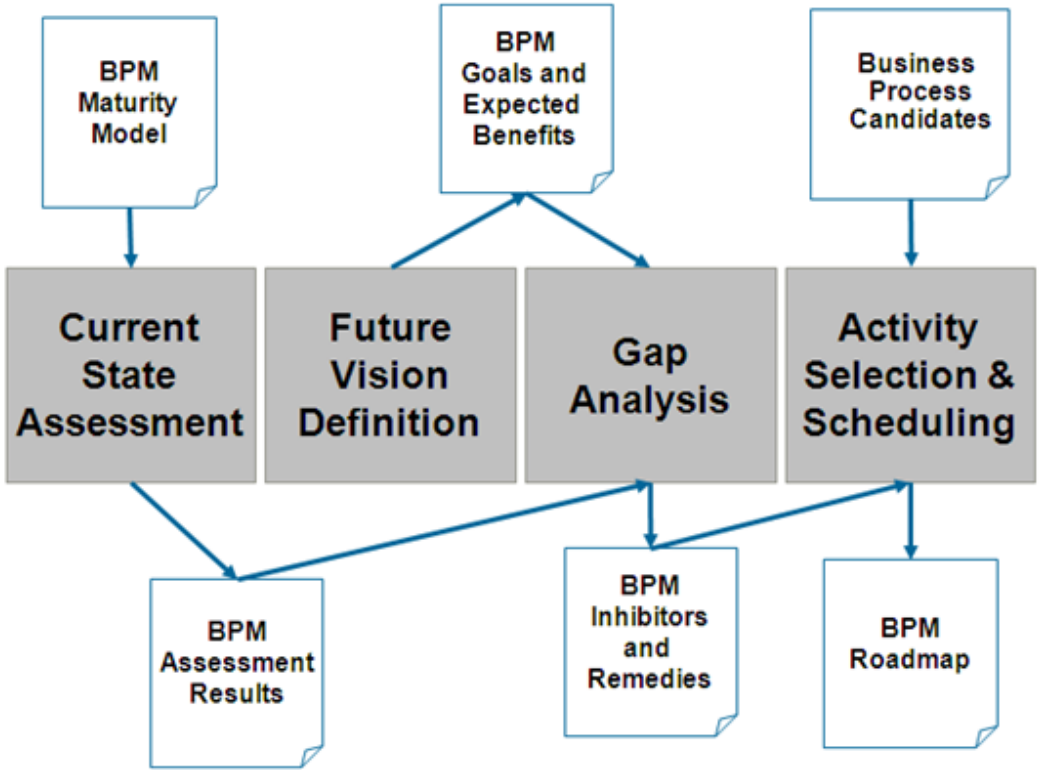
In many cases, application functions (and human workflows within them) are found in vertical applications, information in data silos with human tasks tying them together. In an ideal scenario, a repository of SOA Services will be available for rapid and flexible integration. In cases of other integration strategies (e.g. EAI), more effort is needed to identify and integrate application functions. Human work lists can be managed with portal interfaces and potentially integrated directly with the applications.

However, the initial procedure for placing a business process under the control of a BPM system should not involve significant development of new functions or system replacement of human tasks. Instead, the effort should focus on identifying the human and system functions that make up the steps of the business process and assessing their integration needs. This assessment of integration effort should be performed at the earliest possible stage of planning in order to:

- support the assessment of the process suitability for automation and
- avoid scope creep when engineers are left to make integration decisions later in the engineering process.

Generally, the most effective planning horizon for a BPM Roadmap is 2-3 years. This could be longer or shorter depending on the planning cycles for each organization. The initial phases (e.g., first six months) of the roadmap contain much greater detail than the later phases. This is appropriate and by design. The BPM journey is a journey of discovery, incremental improvement, and regular course corrections. The BPM Roadmap should be regularly reviewed and updated. The business never stays static, so do not expect the BPM Roadmap to remain static either.

The BPM Roadmap Creation Process



There are four areas in the BPM Roadmap view, each with its own set of tasks.

The areas in the BPM Roadmap follow the standard four steps used within the industry to create roadmaps, i.e., establish the current state, define the future vision, analyze the gap, and define the phases and schedule of the roadmap. It is the particulars within each step of the overall process that provide the uniqueness and value of the approach.

CURRENT STATE ASSESSMENT – The current state is measured based on the Oracle BPM Maturity Model. Using this approach to assess the current state of the BPM

initiative provides a consistent measurement scale while keeping the effort focused on capabilities important to BPM success and avoiding the scope creep that frequently undermines current state evaluation efforts. Additional guidance on Current State Assessment can be found in the BPM Roadmap Task Guidelines.

FUTURE VISION DEFINITION – The Future Vision Definition is used to establish the high-level goal and reason for the BPM program. While a fully fleshed out future vision is needed eventually, the initial roadmap creation only requires the high-level vision since the development of the detailed vision can itself be part of the BPM Roadmap. Of course, if the current state of the BPM initiative includes a more detailed future vision, that vision can be leveraged when creating the roadmap. Additional guidance on Future Vision Definition can be found in the BPM Roadmap Task Guidelines.

GAP ANALYSIS – The Gap Analysis evaluates the gap between the current state and the future vision for each of the capabilities. Generally, the capabilities exhibiting the largest gap are given highest priority during the roadmap creation. However, part of Gap Analysis also includes evaluating the relative importance for each of the capabilities for the particular organization. Size, organizational structure, existing assets, funding priorities, even politics can significantly impact the relative importance of capabilities. Additional guidance on Gap Analysis can be found in the BPM Roadmap Task Guidelines.

ACTIVITY SELECTION AND SCHEDULING – Finally, we have Activity Selection and Scheduling that uses the output from the Gap Analysis to create a logical ordering for the work to be done. Emphasis is placed on the program-level efforts for the initial phases to establish the assets and processes used across projects. Candidate business processes are evaluated for BPM applicability and are then prioritized based on that evaluation. The project portfolio is derived from the needs of the business processes selected for automation. Additional guidance on Activity Selection and Scheduling can be found in the BPM Roadmap Task Guidelines.

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WHAT OTHER VIEWS RELATE TO THE BPM ROADMAP VIEW?

Refer to the SOA in OUM page for access as well as descriptions for all the SOA views in OUM.

Refer to the Supplemental Guidance page for further information on the IT Strategies from Oracle (ITSO) web site.

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HOW DOES BPM ROADMAP RELATE TO OUM?

The ITSO BPM Roadmap has been mapped to the Envision focus area of Oracle Unified Method to help show which tasks would typically be performed during each of the four areas, from Current State Assessment to Activity Selection and Scheduling.

See the mapping document and BPM Roadmap view for applicable OUM tasks.

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BUSINESS PROCESS MANAGEMENT (BPM) ROADMAP SUPPLEMENTAL TASK GUIDELINES

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This document contains OUM supplemental task guidance for the execution of a service based on the BPM Roadmap view.

- The first column of the following table provides a complete list of all tasks in this document for which "supplemental" guidelines are provided as well as a quick link to the "supplemental" task guideline in this document.
- The second column provides a link to the OUM Task Overview.

The task guidelines in this document should be used to supplement the guidelines that appear in the OUM Task Overviews.

BPM Roadmap - OUM Supplemental Task Guidelines (this document) collapse table | expand table	OUM Task Overview
Current State Assessment	
BA.012 Define Business Scope	BA.012 Define Business Scope
BA.015 Conduct Enterprise Stakeholder Assessment	BA.015 Conduct Enterprise Stakeholder Assessment
ER.015.1 Conduct Enterprise Maturity Assessment	ER.015.1 Conduct Enterprise Maturity Assessment
ER.040 Research Enterprise	ER.040 Research Enterprise
ER.080 Obtain Existing Reference Material	ER.080 Obtain Existing Reference Material
ER.015.2 Conduct Enterprise Maturity Assessment	ER.015.2 Conduct Enterprise Maturity Assessment
ER.015.3 Conduct Enterprise Maturity Assessment	ER.015.3 Conduct Enterprise Maturity Assessment
Future Vision Definition	
BA.010 Identify Business Strategy	BA.010 Identify Business Strategy
ER.160 Develop Desired Future State	ER.160 Develop Desired Future State
EA.010 Review Architecture Principles, Guidelines and Standards	EA.010 Review Architecture Principles, Guidelines and Standards
Gap Analysis	

ER.165.1 Identify Capability Challenges	ER.165.1 Identify Capability Challenges
ER.165.2 Identify Capability Challenges	ER.165.2 Identify Capability Challenges
ER.165.3 Identify Capability Challenges	ER.165.3 Identify Capability Challenges
ER.167 Determine Remediation Approaches	ER.167 Determine Remediation Approaches
Activity Selection and Scheduling	
ER.130 Produce MoSCoW Improvement List	ER.130 Produce MoSCoW Improvement List
ER.170 Develop Future State Transition Plan	ER.170 Develop Future State Transition Plan
EA.170 Identify Integration Requirements	EA.170 Identify Integration Requirements
BA.040 Create Enterprise Function or Process Model	BA.040 Create Enterprise Function or Process Model
BA.060 Perform High-Level Use Case Discovery	BA.060 Perform High-Level Use Case Discovery
BA.090 Identify Process Improvement Options	BA.090 Identify Process Improvement Options
IP.060 Develop IT Portfolio Plan	IP.060 Develop IT Portfolio Plan

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CURRENT STATE ASSESSMENT

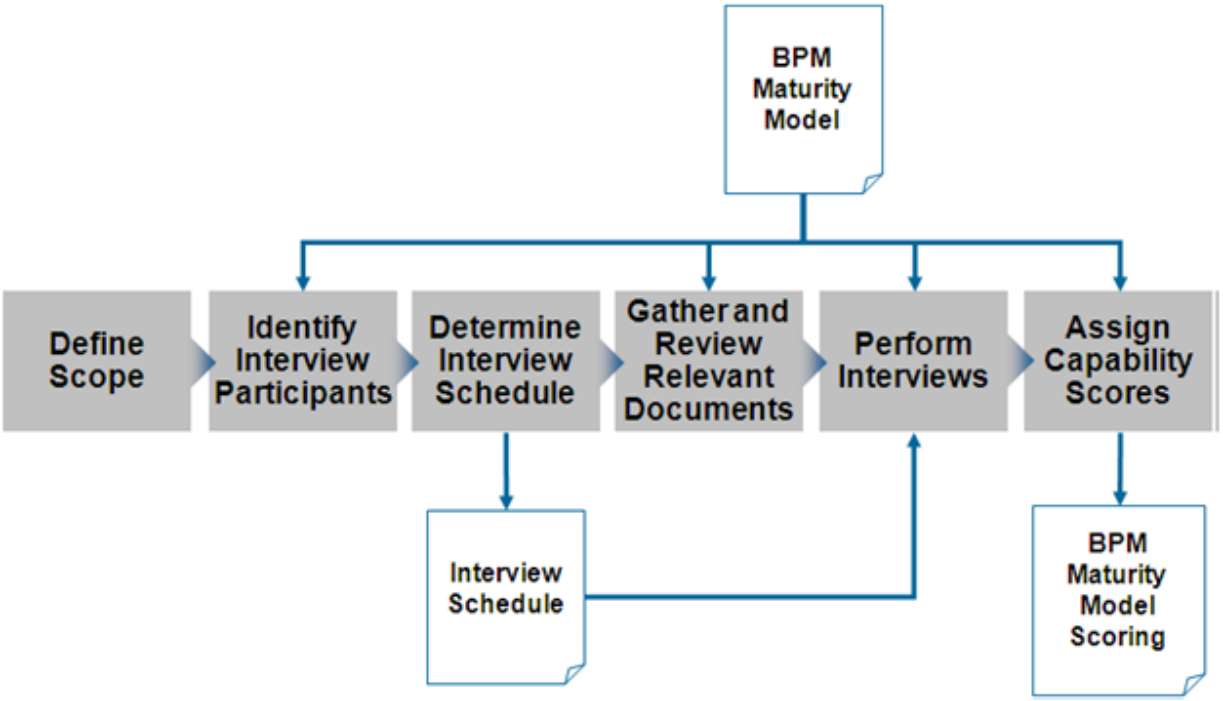
The current state assessment is based on the Oracle BPM Maturity Model. The BPM Maturity Model includes sixty capabilities that capture the best practices that Oracle has collected over many years working with a wide variety of companies. These capabilities provide the detail necessary to accurately measure and guide the progress of a BPM initiative. Focusing the current state assessment on these specific capabilities ensures a focused scope for the assessment.

For more information on the Oracle BPM Maturity Model, go to the Creating a BPM Roadmap document accessible from the IT Strategies from Oracle (ITSO) web site via the Supplemental Guidance page.

The current state assessment should be tightly time-boxed to ensure timely completion of the assessment. The size and complexity of an organization determines the actual amount of time that must be allocated to the assessment. Nominally, two weeks is the amount of time required. The underlying goal is not to fully capture an IT environment current state; rather it is to evaluate the current state relative to the capabilities that are required to successfully adopt BPM.

At the end of the Current State Assessment you will have completed the BPM Maturity Model. This includes the maturity and adoption score for each of the capabilities in the BPM Maturity Matrix. Additionally, the assessment team will have an understanding of the current state and should have collected known issues and problems that were identified and discussed during the interview process.

An overview of the Current State Assessment workflow is as follows:



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BA.012 Define Business Scope

Define Scope

Before beginning the actual assessment, it is vital that the scope of the assessment is determined and that all involved parties agree to the defined scope. For example, the scope could be limited to a single division or line-of-business within a larger enterprise. Or the scope could be limited to a single geographic location. The scope defines both the scope of the assessment *and*, ultimately, the scope of the roadmap.

When doing this you would typically execute task step 1, Create Business Scope Definition, and depending on the result, execute one or multiple of the remaining steps in the task.

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BA.015 Conduct Enterprise Stakeholder Assessment

Identify Interview Participants

To be able to determine which participants should be interviewed as part of the assessment, perform a stakeholder assessment. With the information you have available, identify the key stakeholders (step 3 of the task), their base concerns, interest and influence (step 5).

Choose the participants that ensure that all capabilities within the BPM Maturity Model can be accurately scored. The following table describes the typical areas of interest and interview participants:

Area of Interest	Typical Participant
Business Objectives	VP of Business Units LOB IT
IT Objectives	CIO VP of Application Development VP of IT Infrastructure
Enterprise Architecture	VP of Enterprise Architecture Enterprise Architect(s) Business Specialists / Architects
Program Management	PMO Manager Project Manager(s)
Development Process	Application Architect(s) Business Analyst(s) Business Process Engineer(s) Methodologist Build Manager CM Manager QA Manager
Operations	Director of Operations Administrator(s)
Security	Chief Security Architect

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ER.015.1 Conduct Enterprise Maturity Assessment

Identify Interview Participants

Based on the stakeholder assessment, determine the final list of participants that should be interviewed as part of the assessment.

Determine Interview Schedule

When you have selected the participants you need to interview, determine an interview schedule. The goal is to limit the length of the Current State Assessment by creating a compacted schedule. It may be necessary to delay the start of the assessment to accommodate the participants' schedules. Ideally, try to fit the all the interviews into approximately a two week period. Time before or between interviews can be productive time spent reviewing documentation (i.e., the next task).

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ER.040 Research Enterprise
ER.080 Obtain Existing Reference Material

Gather and Review Relevant Documents

When you have completed the list of interview participants and know the scope of the assessment, gather as much information as possible about the enterprise situation relevant for the assessment as part of the preparation for the interviews. Execute the tasks steps 3, 4 and 5 of ER.040, but as the purpose is to prepare for the interviews, it is not necessary to produce a Discovery Map presentation as a result of this task.

You should also gather any other relevant existing information that may be useful for your interviews preparation. Preferably, the documents to review should be the existing documents that describe various aspects of the current IT environment and BPM initiative. This allows the assessment team to ask more focused questions in the interviews and also provides the opportunity to ask questions about the written material for clarification or to resolve conflicting information. The following list gives some examples of the types of documents that should be gathered and reviewed:

- Balanced Score Card, Strategy Map (or similar business strategy/goals document)
- Enterprise Architecture Document(s)
- Project Management Handbook(s)
- Business Process Model(s)
- Application Functional Breakdown
- Application Portfolio
- Integration Architecture Document(s)
- Operational Process and Procedures Document(s)
- Corporate Security Policies
- Organizational Structure Document (org chart)
- BPM Program Document(s)

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ER.015.2 Conduct Enterprise Maturity Assessment

Perform Interviews

Before each interview the assessment team should review the BPM Maturity Model to identify capabilities that are particularly relevant for the person being interviewed. It is NOT recommended that the assessment team simply ask a question for each of the capabilities. Rather the interview team should ask open ended questions that allow the interviewee to describe how things are currently done and to identify any problems that currently exists. Remember, the interviewees are the experts on what goes on within the organization being evaluated, so encourage them to explain the current situation.

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ER.015.3 Conduct Enterprise Maturity Assessment

Assign Capability Scores

Once the interviews have been completed and the documents have been reviewed, each of the capabilities in the BPM Maturity Matrix should be scored for both maturity and adoption. These scores provide the raw data that is analyzed during Gap Analysis. The BPM Maturity Model includes a description for each level of maturity and each level of adoption for each capability. When scoring a capability, the scores selected should be the scores where the descriptions of maturity level and adoption level most accurately match the current situation based on the information collected in interviews and from the documents reviewed. Although there is always some level of subjectivity when measuring capability, the goal is to provide an objective measure. This allows future measurements to be performed by a different assessment team, yet still provide results that can be used to accurately measure progress.

Frequently, when the assessment results are presented there are questions and even disagreements about the score that was assigned. Therefore, it is important that in addition to the score, the assessment team also records the rational for assigning the maturity and adoption scores. This rational could include quotes from interviews or specific sections from the documents that were reviewed.

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FUTURE VISION DEFINITION

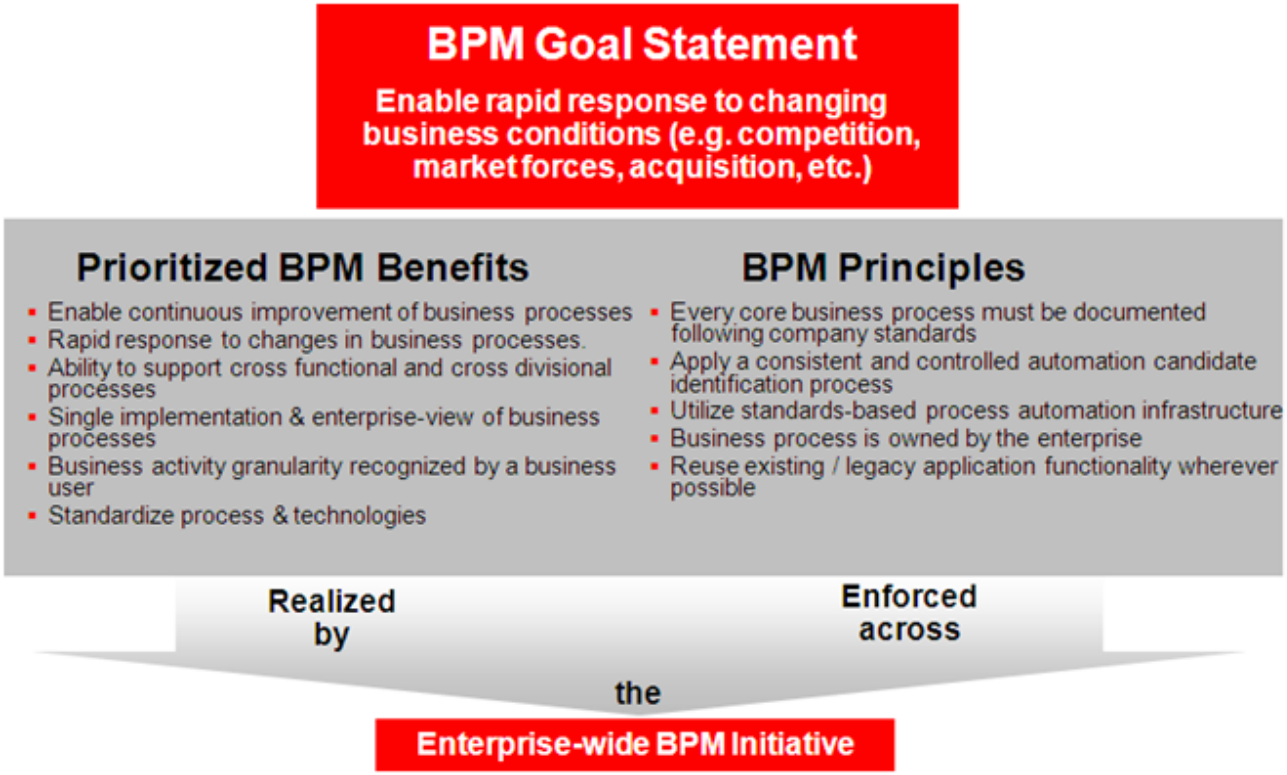
The Future Vision Definition focuses solely on the high-level goals and principles that will be used to guide the entire BPM initiative. Do not attempt to create a detailed future state vision. While a more detailed future vision is required to achieve successful BPM adoption, it is not something that must be created prior to creating the initial BPM Roadmap. The initial phases of the BPM Roadmap may focus on creating the detailed BPM future vision.

The BPM Vision Definition answers the following questions:

1. What is goal of the BPM initiative?
2. What is the organizational scope of the BPM initiative?
3. What are the benefits that BPM is expected to deliver to the organization?
4. What are the guiding principles for the BPM initiative?

These questions must be answered by the executive(s) leading the BPM initiative. This is accomplished in a facilitated workshop. Nominally, the workshop should take about two hours, but may take longer if there is no pre-existing understanding of BPM or there is substantial disagreement on why BPM is being pursued.

At the end of Future Vision Definition, you have a completed BPM Vision Definition. This contains the scope of the initiative, the expected benefits, and the guiding principles to achieve the goal and the benefits. This vision for the BPM initiative can be captured in a single summary slide and used to educate and align the organization with the BPM initiative. The figure below shows an example of such a summary slide:



This picture clearly shows the goal and scope of the BPM initiative. It also shows that the BPM principles will be enforced across the entire BPM initiative and that the BPM initiative is expected to deliver the prioritized benefits.

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BA.010 - Identify Business Strategy

Determine BPM Vision Definition

Review the Business Strategy and identify areas relevant for BPM. In particular, task steps 4 (Determine Vision, Mission and/or Values) and 6 (Determine Goals, Objectives, Targets and Initiatives) are relevant. Use this as an input to prepare the goals of the BPM initiative. This should help you in answering the question, “What is the goal of the BPM initiative?” above. The goal being defined should be the goal for the BPM initiative after having executed the roadmap.

The recommended roadmap planning horizon is 2-3 years; therefore the goal should be the goal of the BPM initiative 2-3 years from now. The following table provides some example goal statements:

Goal Statement	Score
Enable rapid response to changing business conditions (for example, competition, market forces, acquisition, etc.	5
Develop a cycle of continuous improvement of business processes.	5
Monitor business process efficiency and effectiveness of change based on Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)	4
Improve business process transparency and visibility for improved control and consistency.	3
Facilitate streamlining of human tasks through automation.	2
Apply BPM to a limited set of projects to demonstrate the benefits of BPM and build credibility with the business owners.	1
Improve business/IT alignment through common business process language and shared repositories.	1

The goal statements in the above table are used to gauge the extent and complexity of the entire BPM initiative and are listed in order of increasing difficulty. It should be obvious that accomplishing the first goal statement is far less difficult than accomplishing the fifth goal statement. Greater organizational maturity is required to achieve the more difficult goals for BPM. Of course, the benefits provided by BPM are commensurably greater as well. The Score column in the table is used (and will be explained) during Gap Analysis.

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ER.160 Develop Desired Future State

Determine BPM Vision Definition

Once you have determined the BPM Goal statement (see BA.010 Identify Business Strategy), you should answer the second question above, “What is the organizational scope of the BPM initiative?” The organizational scope defines which departments, divisions, lines-of-business, etc., are included in the BPM initiative. The most common scopes are either division or enterprise, but other options are possible depending on the company's organizational structure. The following table provides example levels of scope for the BPM initiative.

BPM Initiative Scope	Score

A small number of projects will be applying process orientation.	1
One or more business units will use BPM to address all of their projects.	2
The BPM initiative will span all business units within a single division.	3
The BPM initiative will span multiple divisions within the enterprise.	4
The BPM initiative will span the entire enterprise.	5

Defining the scope of the BPM initiative is essential to determining a roadmap. With greater scope, the number of organizational boundaries that must be crossed increases. This increases the complexity of the effort, and, therefore, requires greater organizational maturity. The Score column in the table is used (and will be explained) during Gap Analysis.

Finally, you should identify the list of expected BPM benefits that the organization realistically can achieve within the given timeframe, and with a successful adoption of BPM. This will help answer the third question,"What are the benefits that BPM is expected to deliver to the organization?"

There are many different benefits that an organization can realize by successfully adopting BPM. However, not all benefits can be realized in parallel. When creating a BPM Roadmap, emphasis should be placed on the benefits that are highest priority and leave the lower priority benefits for later phases. The list below shows examples of possible benefits from BPM adoption.

- continuous improvement of business processes
- rapid deployment of business processes
- rapid / flexible process business change
- flexible architecture that enables business and IT agility
- ability to support cross functional and cross divisional processes
- effective use of external service providers
- single implementation and enterprise-view of business processes
- operational improvements
- process granularity recognized by a business user
- skill-set portability
- standardize process and technologies
- standards-based integration
- quicker re-composition of business processes
- integration with business partners
- extending value of legacy applications
- better visibility into business processes
- efficiency and/or consistency through automation
- business process standardization
- decoupling of applications
- productivity gains

These benefits can be used as a starting place to identify the benefits that an organization hopes to achieve via BPM adoption. The above list is by no means a complete list. Part of the BPM Vision Definition is to create a list of possible BPM benefits and prioritize the list. Once a list has been created, the benefits should be prioritized based on the business and IT objectives of the organization. The easiest way to prioritize the benefits is to assign a high, medium, or low prioritization to each possible benefit. Roughly one third of the possible benefits should be in each prioritization, i.e., it is not helpful to list all the possible benefits as high priority.

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EA.010 Review Architecture Principles, Guidelines and Standards

Determine BPM Vision Definition

The BPM Vision Definition is completed by defining a number of guiding principles. This answers the final question, “What are the guiding principles for the BPM initiative?” The principles should be defined to support the highest prioritized benefits, and should thereby provide enforceable guidance to the BPM initiative. The following list provides some example guiding principles.

- Every core business process must be documented following company standards.
- Apply a consistent and controlled automation candidate identification process.
- Utilize a standards-based process automation infrastructure.
- Business process is owned by the enterprise.
- Reuse existing / legacy application functionality wherever possible.

The guiding principles should be sufficiently clear and detailed so that the principles can be enforced across the entire scope of the BPM initiative and on specific projects that fall under the purview of the initiative. The principles should also serve as a foundation to make more specific decisions in the future.

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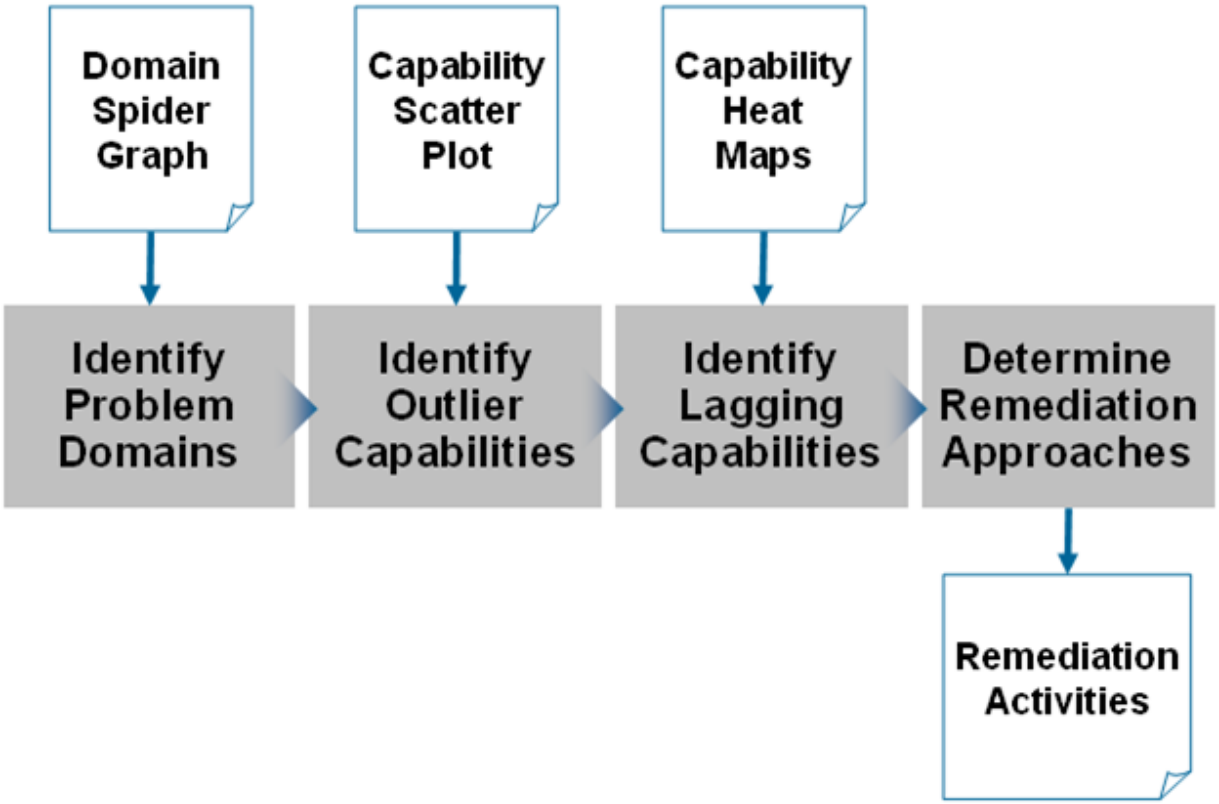
GAP ANALYSIS

During Gap Analysis, the current state of the BPM initiative (as measured during the Current State Assessment above) is compared with the goal for the initiative (defined during Future Vision Definition above). The gap between these two is then analyzed to determine the causes and identify remediation approaches.

The maturity and adoption scores from the Current State Assessment measure the progress of a BPM initiative and, more importantly, identifies specific capabilities that are lacking or lagging and are therefore inhibiting the BPM initiative. The gap between where the organization is currently and where they need to be to achieve their goal is broken down by capability domain (from the BPM Maturity Model) to identify lagging domains. It is further broken down by individual capability to identify specific capabilities that are lacking or lagging. The following diagram illustrates the workflow.



Once the lagging capabilities have been identified, a remediation approach for each of the identified inhibitors is determined from industry best practices and prior Oracle experience.

At the end of the Gap Analysis, you have the Remediation Activities at domain level. This includes an understanding of which domains and which individual capabilities are inhibiting the successful achievement of the goal of the BPM initiative. Additionally, it includes identified remediation activities that address the lagging domains and capabilities. The Remediation Activities provide the primary input into the roadmap creation.

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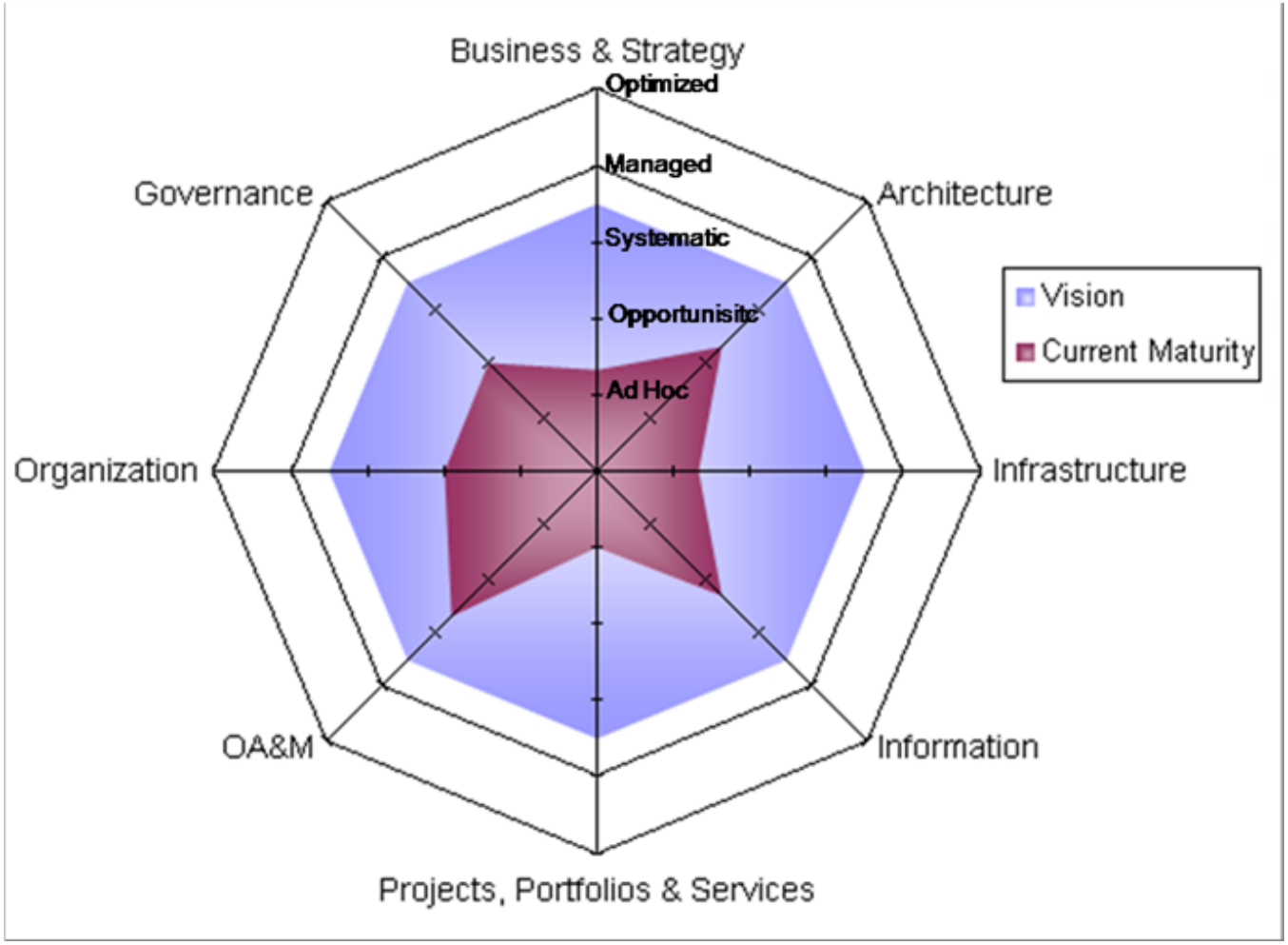
ER.165.1 Identify Capability Challenges

IDENTIFY PROBLEM DOMAINS

The first step of Gap Analysis is to identify the domains that exhibit the largest gap between current maturity and the maturity needed to achieve the BPM goal. The gap for the domains can be visually represented by a spider (aka radar) graph as shown below:



Vision versus Current Maturity

The Vision level is determined by the following formula:

$$V_S = \begin{cases} G_S, \text{ if } G_S \geq S_S \\ (G_S + S_S)/2, \text{ if } G_S < S_S \end{cases}$$

Where **GS** is the score from the goal statement and **SS** is the score from the scope of the BPM initiative. This formula maps the goal statement to a level of maturity necessary to reach that goal. The scope of the initiative is used as a modifier if the scope score is greater than the goal score, i.e., it takes greater maturity to achieve success on a broader scope. The vision score (**VS**) is then mapped to the maturity levels in the BPM Maturity Model by applying the simple formula: 1=Ad Hoc, 2=Opportunistic, … , 5=Optimized.

For the example in the spider graph shown above, the Vision level was derived using this formula as follows:

Goal Statement - Improve business process transparency and visibility for improved control and consistency.

Scope Statement - The BPM initiative will span multiple divisions within the enterprise.

So **Gs** = 3, **Ss** = 4, and **Vs** = (3+4)/2 = 3.5. The 3.5 score mapped to the maturity levels yields a vision maturity half way between Systematic and Managed. This Vision level of maturity is what is plotted in the spider graph figure.

The Current Maturity level for each domain is calculated by simply averaging the maturity score for each capability within the domain. This provides an average maturity for each of the eight domains which is then plotted in the spider graph.

Plotting the Current Maturity relative to the Vision (as shown in the spider graph above) provides a visual representation of the gap between where the organization is with respect to BPM and where it needs to be to meet the goal of the BPM initiative. In this example, the graph clearly shows that the Projects, Portfolios & Services domain is the area requiring the most attention followed closely by the Business & Strategy and Infrastructure domains.

This analysis should be fed into Activity Selection and Scheduling. In this example, initial activities in the roadmap should center on addressing the lagging capabilities in the Projects, Portfolios and Services, Business and Strategy, and Infrastructure domains.

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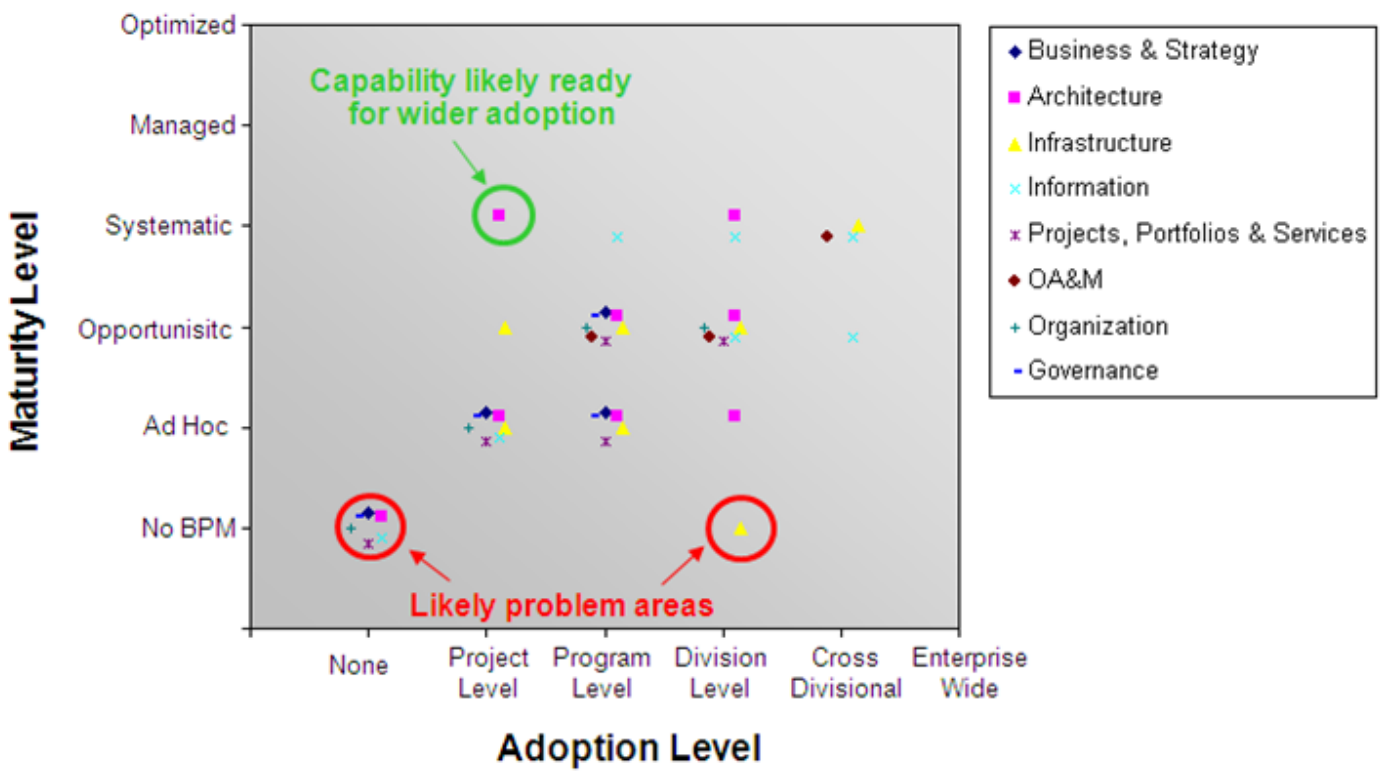
ER.165.2 Identify Capability Challenges

Identify Outlier Capabilities

Outlier capabilities are capabilities where the maturity and the adoption are significantly out of sync. This usually indicates a capability that should receive attention early in the roadmap. The outlier capabilities can be easily detected by plotting the maturity and adoption score for each capability in a scatter plot as shown in the following figure:



Capabilities Scatter Plot

As shown in the above graph, the maturity and adoption scores for capabilities usually fall along the diagonal when plotted against each other. In the above example, there are two scores that are significantly off the diagonal, one well above the diagonal and one well below the diagonal. The capability well above the diagonal is a capability from the Architecture domain. The capability well below the diagonal is a capability from the Infrastructure domain. The analyst will need to review the actual capability scores to identify exactly which capabilities yielded the outlier points on the graph.

A capability that falls well above the diagonal indicates a capability that is done very well within a relatively small area of the organization. In this example, there is a capability at a Systematic level of maturity done within a single project. Fostering greater adoption of this capability provides an easy win for the BPM initiative, i.e., there is no need to develop greater competency for this capability within the organization since it already exists within the organization. Some training or mentoring can spread the ability more broadly within the organization.

A capability well below the diagonal indicates a capability that is done poorly (or in a non-BPM compliant fashion) very broadly. In this example, there is a capability being done at a No BPM level of maturity across the entire division. Corrective action needs to be taken for this capability since if left uncorrected, it will inhibit (and probably already has inhibited) the BPM initiative.

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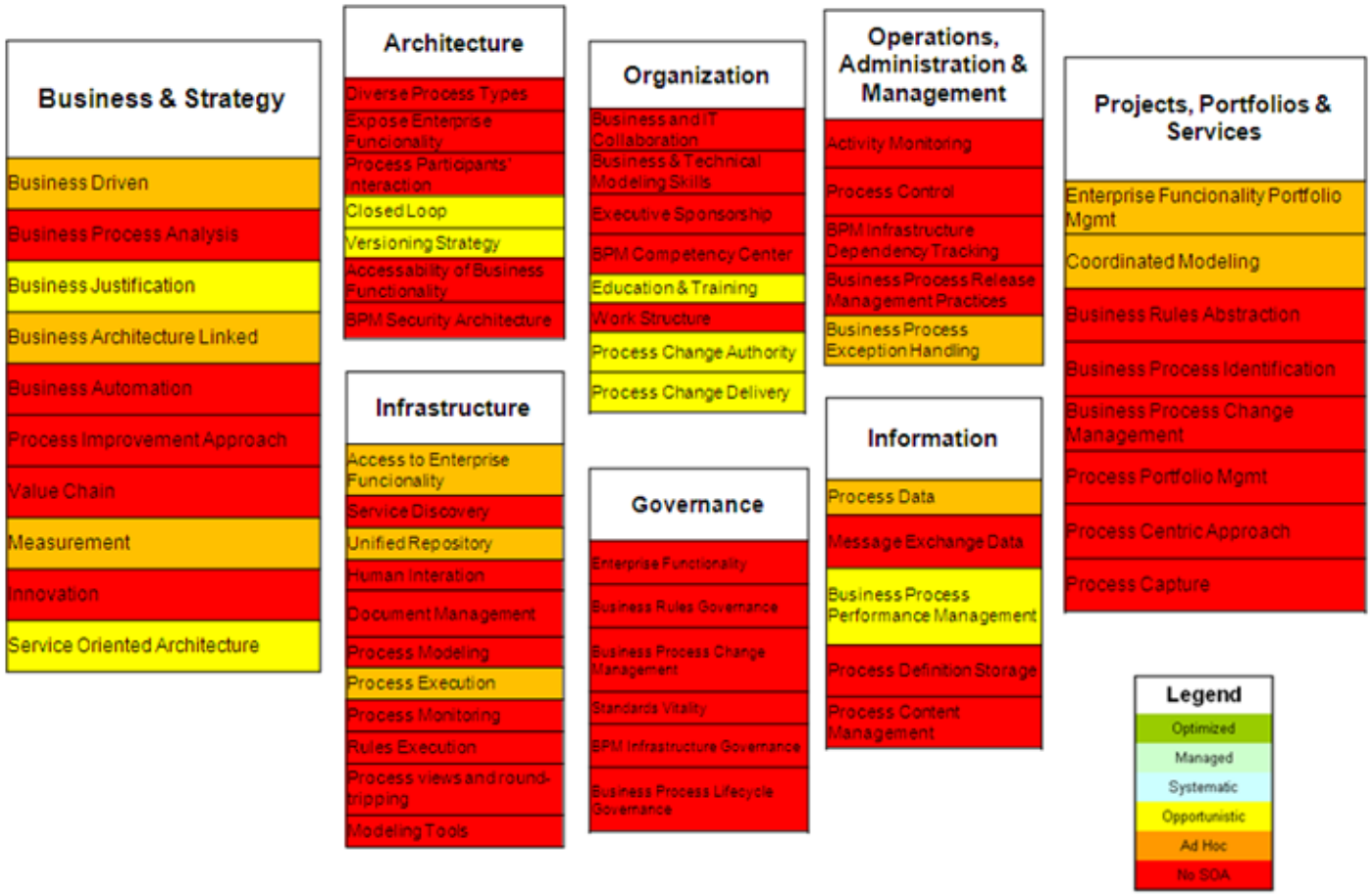
ER.165.3 Identify Capability Challenges

Identify Lagging Capabilities

The lagging capabilities would typically require attention in early phases of the roadmap. These are the capabilities that plot nearer the lower left corner in the scatter plot above. Capability heat maps can be used to visually identify these low maturity capabilities as shown in the following figure:



Capabilities Heat Map

The capabilities heat map colors each of the capabilities based on the maturity score recorded for that capability. The above diagram shows the color coding legend as well as each capability with color coding applied. The capabilities are organized by the domains used in the BPM Maturity Model. The heat map draws immediate attention to the capabilities that require attention. In the above example, there are five capabilities in the Business and Strategy domain (Business Process Analysis, Business Automation, Process Improvement Approach, Value Chain and Innovation) that scored at the No BPM level of maturity. These capabilities should be addressed in early phases of the BPM Roadmap. Likewise, there are six capabilities in the Projects, Portfolios and Services domain that scored at the No BPM level of maturity. All of the capabilities in the Governance domain were scored at the No BPM level of maturity, an obvious indicator that BPM is very immature for this organization.

You should review each capability with a low score and determine whether it is a top priority, a low priority, or unimportant from a roadmap creation perspective. If a capability is deemed unimportant for a particular organization, it should be removed from the maturity model and the graphics should be regenerated. This should be done with caution. A capability should only be removed if it is clearly not appropriate for the BPM initiative at this organization.

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ER.167 Determine Remediation Approaches

Determine Remediation Approaches

At this point in Gap Analysis, the problem domains have been identified and the problem capabilities within each domain have also been identified. The next step is to identify remedies for each problem domain and capability. Obviously, the remedies depend on the problem being addressed and frequently have some aspect that is organization specific. Therefore, unfortunately, it is not possible to provide a prescriptive approach to determining remediation activities for all 60 capabilities. However, there are some general guidelines based on the domains that can usually be applied to creating remediation activities, as shown in the table below:

Domain	Remediation Approach
Business & Strategy	Remediation for this domain and the capabilities within this domain usually requires executive management decisions and directives. A common remediation activity is a facilitated workshop with appropriate executives to define the necessary strategies, make decisions, and formulate directives.
Architecture	Low scores in this domain usually indicate the lack of a reference architecture for the BPM initiative, or if the reference architecture exists, it lacks completeness and details. Remediation usually entails workshops with enterprise architects to specify a complete, detailed reference architecture.
Infrastructure	Low scores in this domain usually indicate that the process infrastructure is lacking significant elements. Infrastructure installation and configuration type projects are common remediation activities.
Information	Low scores in this domain usually indicate issues with the information architecture, data quality approach, and/or information stewardship. Common remediation activities are workshops to address the causes for the low scores.
Operations, Administration & Management	Remediation activities for low scores in this domain usually entail definition, documentation, and enforcement of BPM compatible.
OA&M Procedures	Low scores could be due to lacking BPM knowledge/skills or could be due to a low maturity of OA&M in general.
Projects, Portfolios & Services	Low scores in this domain usually indicate a lack of BPM compatible management and delivery processes. Common remediation activities entail workshops to modify existing management and delivery processes to inject BPM best practices.
Organization	Low scores in this domain usually indicate that roles and responsibilities appropriate for BPM have not been instituted within the organization. There may also be a lack of BPM knowledge/skills. Common remediation activities include developing training plans and workshops to define the necessary roles and responsibilities. Remediation may also require organization restructuring.
Governance	Most organizations have existing IT governance in place, so low scores in this domain usually indicate that governance has not been extended to cover BPM. Remediation usually requires a workshop to define and institute the governance extensions required for BPM.

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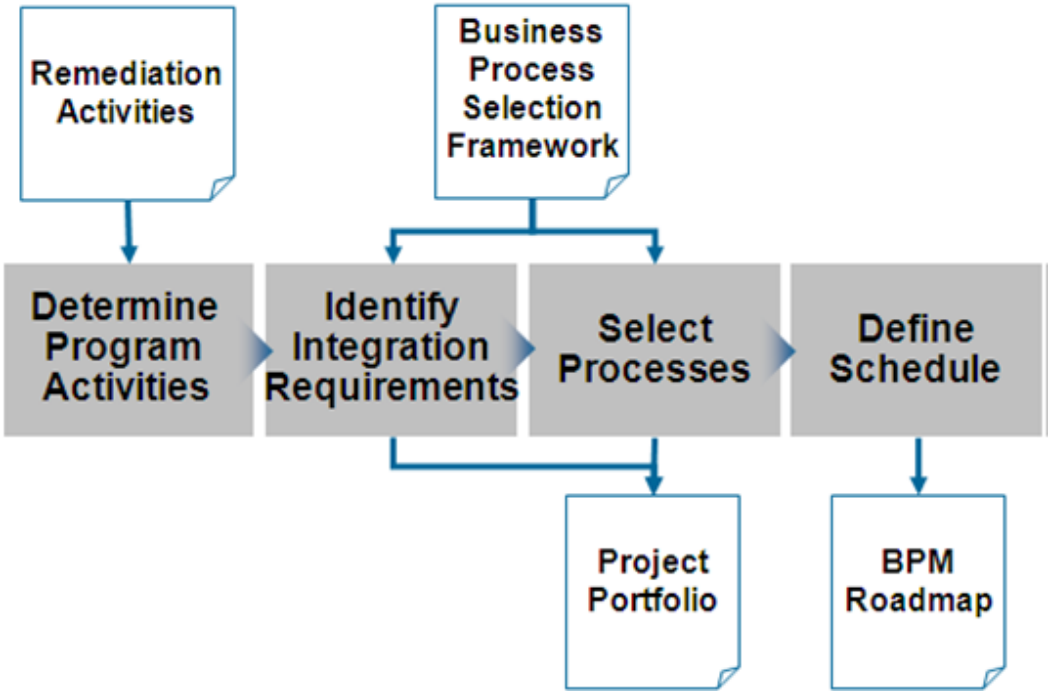
ACTIVITY SELECTION AND SCHEDULING

During Activity Selection and Scheduling, prioritize the remedies that you identified during Gap Analysis and use this to create a plan, called the BPM Roadmap. Business processes are evaluated to select the business processes that are most appropriate for application of BPM technology. This should not be equated to evaluating the value of the business process itself; rather it measures the benefits (versus the risks) of the application of BPM technology.

There are four steps in Activity Selection and Scheduling:



At the end of the Activity Selection and Scheduling you have a completed BPM Roadmap.

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ER.130 Produce MoSCoW Improvement List

Determine Program Activities

The first step when determining the program activities is to prioritize the remediation activities identified in the Gap Analysis. Top priority is usually given to remediation activities that focus on the domain with lowest current maturity score. Top priority remediation activities are usually the first activities in the roadmap since the results from these activities are leveraged across the solution and service delivery efforts.

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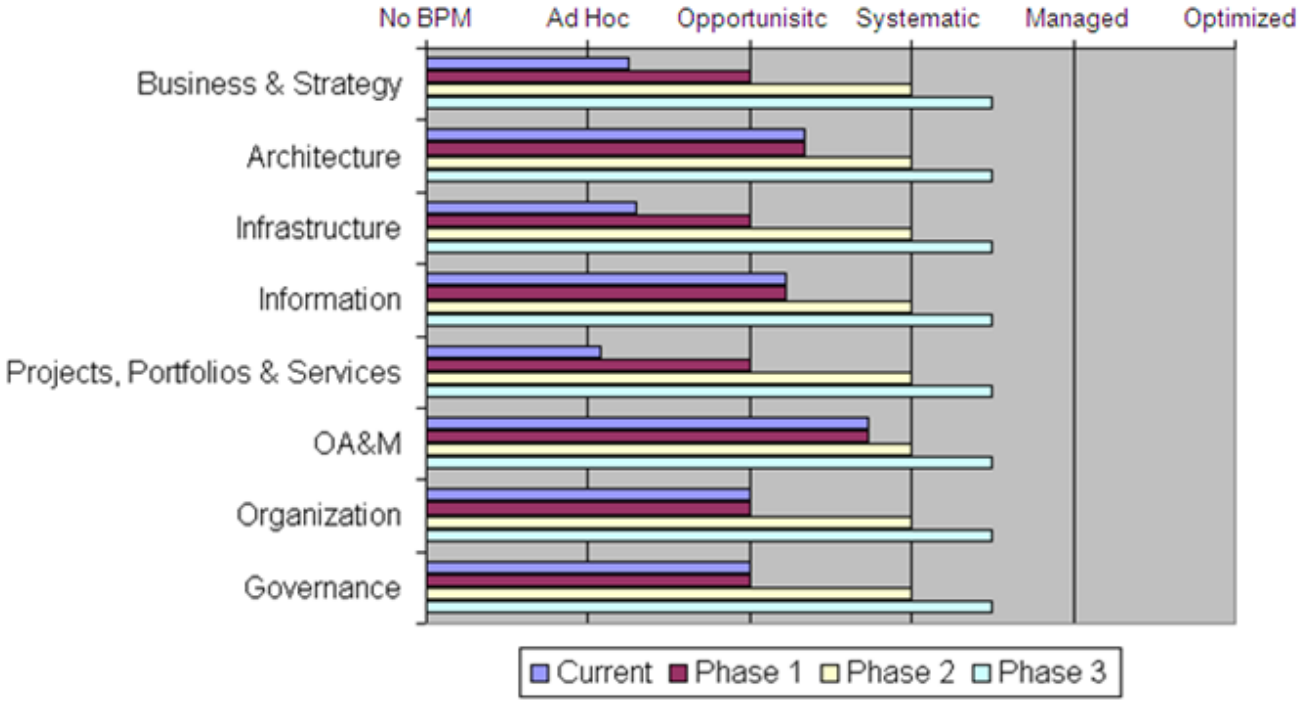
ER.170 Develop Future State Transition Plan

Determine Program Activities

After the program activities have been prioritized, determine when each of the activities should best be executed, and split the BPM Roadmap into phases.

Program-level activities frequently entail changes with wide-ranging impacts. For example, changing the software development process (to inject process-oriented best practices) impacts all development teams within the scope of the BPM initiative.

Organizational changes can be even more taxing. Therefore, it is usually necessary to undertake these changes in a series of iterations. These iterations become the phases of the overall BPM Roadmap. At a high level, this can be shown graphically as illustrated by the figure below:



Increasing Maturity Over Time

The graph illustrates three iterations each increasing maturity of one or more domains until the desired vision level of maturity is achieved. Notice that the first phase focuses on bringing all domains up to the **Opportunistic** level of maturity. This means that the first phase will include remedy activities for the Business & Strategy, Infrastructure, and Projects, Portfolios & Services domains. Once near parity is achieved across domains, follow-on phases address the eight domains more uniformly to keep the BPM initiative progressing smoothly.

The amount of change introduced by an iteration must not exceed the organization's ability to absorb that change; therefore the scope of each iteration must be carefully planned. Likewise, the duration of each iteration must be long enough to accomplish some meaningful progress, yet remain short enough to minimize risk and maintain a continuous pace of incremental progress.

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EA.170 Identify Integration Requirements

Identify Integration Requirements

This is done in parallel with the next step, select processes.

Having selected the program level activities, the next step is to identify processes that should be included in the roadmap. One of the selection criteria used for the process candidates is the accessibility of functionality from existing applications. It may be necessary to make modifications to these applications to support the new project. There are two main types of changes:

1. integration efforts
2. implement functional enhancements to existing applications and SOA services

The new process should not require additional capacity or better performance than the existing applications or SOA services currently provide since, in principle, the business process is not changing. However, it is important to be aware of possible changes to non-functional aspects and the potential for increased demands on the application.

The most likely case is that the existing application or SOA service needs extensions to support the integration in the process automation. These changes should be factored in to the process selection and the effort and integration approach clearly established in advance of project start. Ideally the changes can be done in a backward compatible manner; thereby allowing existing consumers of the SOA services to move to the new version deployed to support the new process.

Typically, integration requirements are best satisfied through a SOA approach; however, since a new SOA project is likely to provide additional benefits such projects should be justified separately using the SOA Roadmap planning and engineering strategies.

It is possible that the required business application functions do not currently exist anywhere in the organization. In this case, the process candidate may support justification for the development of application or service capabilities in a separate engineering project.

Any of the above types of change to existing application functionality or SOA services needs to be reflected in the BPM Roadmap, regardless of whether or not they are handed off to a separate project. Obviously, the processes that use the SOA services have a dependency on the external change activities so these dependencies must be captured in the roadmap.

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BA.040 Create Enterprise Function or Process Model
BA.060 Perform High-Level Use Case Discovery
BA.090 Identify Process Improvement Options

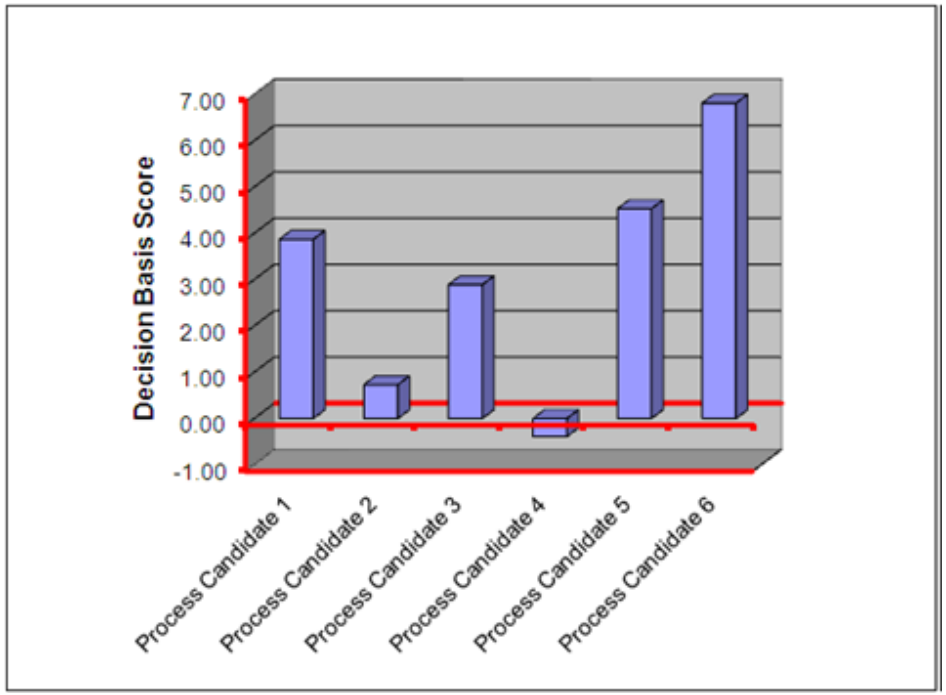
Select Processes

When selecting candidates for process automation, use a combination of the tasks BA.040 (Create Enterprise Function of Process Model), BA.060 (Perform High-Level Use Case Discovery), and BA.090 (Identify Process Improvement Options) to determine a list of processes relevant for your BPM Roadmap. Look at the earlier identified integration requirements and use the Enterprise Process Model to see which processes are the ones relevant for further investigation. It is possible that the required business application functions do not currently exist anywhere in the organization, so you perform a high-level use case discovery to identify these. You also look for relevant process improvement options that you may see based on the identified integration requirements.

There are three primary areas to analyze to identify the process automation candidates:

1. alignment with strategic goals
2. value of benefits, such as frequency of process change, opportunities for optimization, etc.
3. availability and accessibility of required business application functions

If the required business application functions do not currently exist anywhere in the organization, then the process candidate may support justification for the development of application or SOA service capabilities in a separate engineering project. Process candidate identification and analysis is a large topic and is beyond the scope of this document, but you can see the example of a result of a process candidate analysis in the figure below:



Process Candidate Analysis

This example shows six business process candidates. A Decision Base Score has been calculated for each of the process candidates based on a number of characteristics, typically related to the three areas mentioned above. A positive Decision Basis Score indicates a process candidate that should be realized into an automated process. Thus, process candidates 1, 2, 3, 5, and 6 should be included in the BPM Roadmap with process candidates 5 and 6 tackled in the earliest phase of the roadmap. Process candidate 4 should not be realized (at this time). The process candidates that are selected should be included in the BPM Roadmap. Process candidates that are not selected should be recorded for future iterations of the roadmap. Although the process candidate did not make the cut for this iteration of the roadmap, it might very well make the cut in a future iteration.

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IP.060 Develop IT Portfolio Plan

Define Schedule

The final step in the BPM Roadmap is to define the schedule for the Roadmap. This schedule should be the schedule for the entire BPM initiative; thus it is the high-level schedule that illustrates the ordering and dependency relationships between program-level activities, the selected projects, service modifications, and the selected process candidates.

We have seen an example of how the phases of a BPM Roadmap may be in the figure, Increasing Maturity Over Time; however, this figure does not include actual timelines since that could not be determined until the projects, integrations and process candidates were identified. The steps to put together the schedule are as follows:

1. Create the program level activities schedule.
2. Create high-level project schedule.
3. Determine delivery dates for application integrations and service modifications.
4. Determine delivery dates for process candidates.

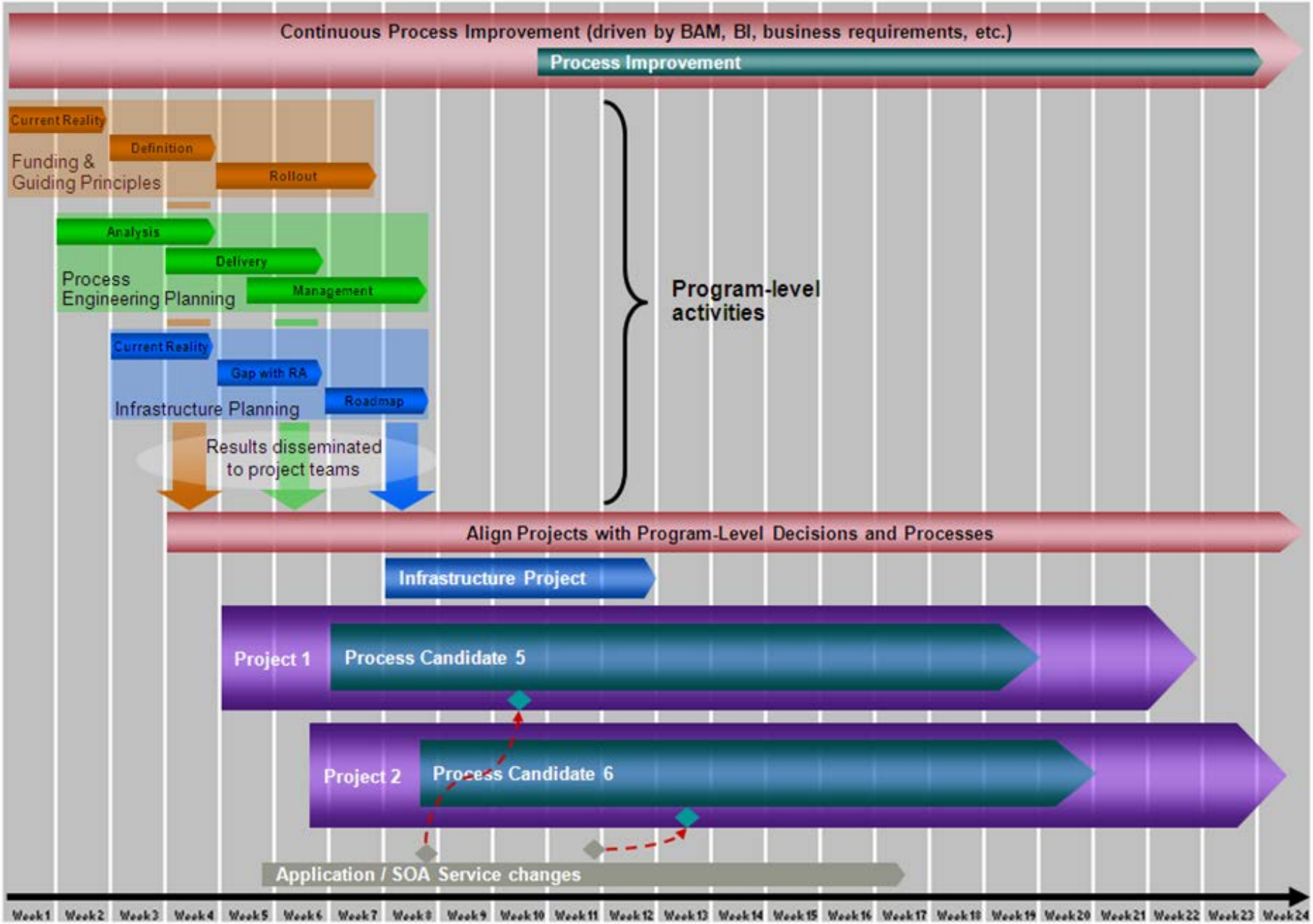
The first activity of defining the schedule is to determine the start date and duration for the program level activities. These are the initial activities put into the BPM Roadmap.

The next step is to determine the start dates for the selected projects. Projects that are expected to leverage the outcomes of the program level activities (usually all projects) should not begin in earnest until the program-level activities complete. Some overlap is allowed since the earliest phases of a project (e.g., Inception) can usually commence before the program-level activities are completed. The end date for the project is determined by effort, complexity, and resource availability. Sometimes the end date is mandated by business needs. In either case, the end date for the project is put into the schedule.

The delivery dates for the application integrations and SOA service modifications are determined by the needs of the project requiring the changes. Generally, the integrations and SOA service modifications must be available in time for project integration testing. Of course, an earlier delivery date is certainly acceptable and is, in fact, preferable.

Most of the projects included in the BPM Roadmap will have business process management automation as the primary delivery of the project. Exceptions include the infrastructure projects that deliver the shared BPM infrastructure used by multiple process management automation projects. The delivery dates for the selected business processes are determined and are incorporated into the schedule. The delivery dates for the selected business processes lie within the enclosing project delivery time line.

At this point, any resource constraints need to be incorporated into the schedule. This may require that start dates are delayed or durations may increase. Once these constraints have been included, a schedule can be created and might look something like the schedule shown in the next figure:



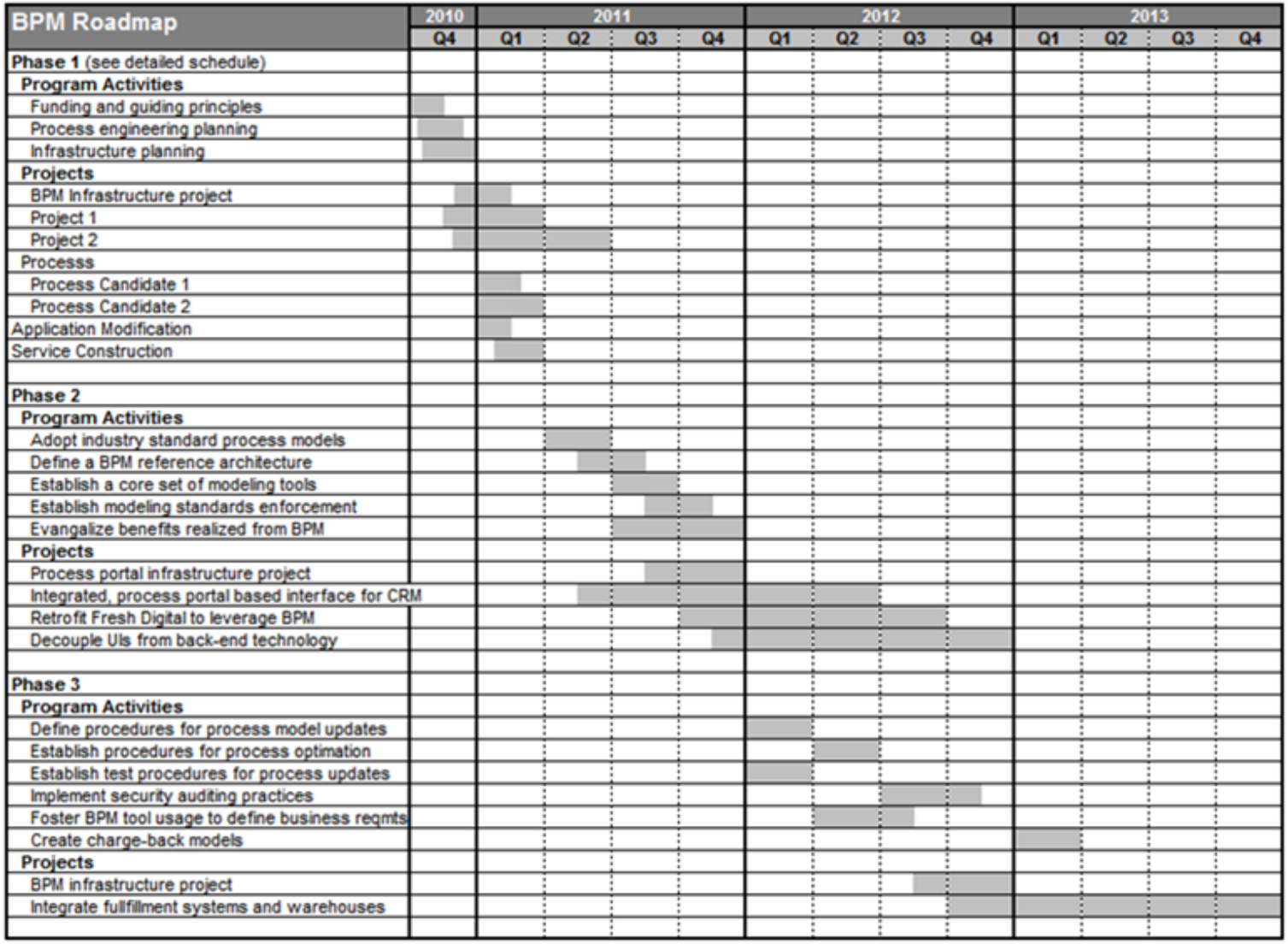
Roadmap Phase 1 Schedule

The above schedule begins with three program-level activities to address the three domains (Business & Strategy, Projects, Portfolios & Services, and Infrastructure) that scored below the Opportunistic maturity level. The results from the program level activities are then disseminated to all the projects and process candidate realization activities shown in the bottom half of the figure. The Infrastructure Project shown in the roadmap delivers the BPM infrastructure used by the other two projects shown.

This process Infrastructure Project is focused purely on realizing the process infrastructure such as defined in the Oracle Reference Architecture paper, BPM Infrastructure. The Infrastructure Planning (that was part of the program level activities) defines what technologies and products are deployed by the Infrastructure Project.

Project 1 and Project 2 both deliver the automation of business processes (Process Candidate 5 and Process Candidate 6). The two process candidates are those that we could see had the highest Decision Base Score in the Process Candidate Analysis. Finally, the graphic shows the application and SOA service modifications that are required to support the projects. This is to expose the necessary functionality that is required by the tasks in the business processes.

As discussed earlier, the detail in the initial phase of the BPM Roadmap will be much greater than the detail provided for the later phases. The later phases likely include additional program-level activities and more projects and the process candidates on which they are dependent, but will contain less detail. An example of such a schedule is shown in the next figure:



BPM Roadmap Subsequent Phases

The first phase schedule was broken down into weeks but only covered two quarters. This schedule covers the entire planning horizon (three years) but with significantly less detail. The projects chosen for the first phase were relatively short in duration and effort. This is to help ensure early wins for the BPM initiative. Subsequent phases can then afford to undertake more complex efforts (e.g., legacy sun-setting) that could take years to complete.

Subsequent phases will also likely have additional infrastructure projects that continue to build out the reference architecture. The capabilities of the reference architecture built out in each phase depend on the needs of the projects and services that are included in the phase.

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